CHELSEA HALLFORD

AI CHIEF OF STAFF | CEO STRATEGY & EXECUTION | STARTUP OPERATIONS

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EXECUTIVE PROFILE

AI-native Chief of Staff and startup operator who independently translates CEO direction into enterprise-wide execution. Trusted to run the business operating cadence while the CEO focuses on sales and fundraising; builds scalable systems across strategy, revenue, people, finance, product and partnerships. Combines high emotional intelligence and collaborative leadership with hands-on AI automation, disciplined accountability and commercial ownership.

SELECTED BUSINESS IMPACT

$600K / First signed SLED deal (3 years) • $200K / Annual SLED starter offering • ~$186K / Annual benefits savings • 80% / Less manual admin and reporting

CHIEF OF STAFF | KAMIWAZA | FEB 2025 – PRESENT

Directly own cross-functional execution, operational design and leadership alignment for an AI startup, serving as the CEO's day-to-day operating counterpart.

CEO PARTNERSHIP, STRATEGY & OPERATING CADENCE

- Translate a single 30-minute weekly CEO alignment conversation into prioritized initiatives, executive follow-through and clear direction across his direct reports; meet individually with CEO staff every week to remove obstacles and drive decisions.
- Established quarterly leadership offsites and planning sessions; designed the Big Rocks framework, quarterly initiative tracking, red/yellow/green reporting and escalation discipline to make priorities measurable and actionable.
- Own executive 5T5 reporting, weekly CEO Staff Top 1 & 5, enterprise sales and partnership reviews, and monthly company goal updates; maintain visibility into bookings, engineering milestones and launches.

AI TRANSFORMATION, AUTOMATION & DASHBOARDS

- Designed integrated executive dashboards and deployed six AI agents to handle recurring administrative and reporting workflows, reducing manual overhead by approximately 80% and freeing the CEO staff and executive leadership team for higher-value work.
- Built AI-enabled workflows for meeting intelligence, inbox triage, NDA collection, executive reporting and people operations; test and adopt tools directly rather than relying on theoretical AI strategy.

REVENUE, SLED GO-TO-MARKET & PARTNERSHIPS

- Solely productized the state, local and education (SLED) offering into a repeatable $200K annual starter package with standardized $50K support packages, simplifying pricing and commercial delivery.
- Personally drove the company's first signed SLED agreement: a $600K, three-year deal; coordinated customer, partner and internal workstreams from offering development through close.
- Advanced partner onboarding, NDA collection, HubSpot deal-registration automation and services delivery processes; coordinated municipal and HPE partner activities.

PEOPLE LEADERSHIP, TALENT & CULTURE

- Own recruiting, hiring governance, onboarding, performance conversations, employee communications and separations; personally recruited and onboarded both marketing leaders.
- Built structured interview loops, hiring-manager RACI, candidate tracking and recruiter onboarding; use empathy, direct communication and conflict resolution to build an upbeat, accountable and collaborative culture.

FINANCE, BENEFITS & GOVERNANCE

- Led PEO migration from Extensis to TriNet, including vendor evaluation, benefits enrollment, 401(k) transition and payroll-to-GL mapping; negotiated approximately $186K in annual company and employee healthcare savings.
- Run weekly finance and operations reviews; support close, board consents, 409A valuation and Carta cap-table cleanup; led Google Drive access restructuring aligned with ISO security requirements.

PRODUCT, EXECUTIVE REPRESENTATION & EVENTS

- Hands-on tester of Kamiwaza and Kaizen experiences; identify defects, document reproducible feedback and validate customer workflows, including municipal deed-restriction use cases.
- Represent CEO at executive briefings and industry events; moderated a sold-out AI-in-housing conference session and established event approvals, tracking and ROI reporting.

EARLIER LEADERSHIP EXPERIENCE

SUMO LOGIC | Senior Executive Business Partner, Chief of Staff Scope | Nov 2023 – Mar 2025

- Strategic partner to 3+ C-level leaders; orchestrated executive operating cadence, strategy offsites, pre-reads and cross-functional priorities.

ALLCLOUD | Partner Alliances Manager | 2021 – Jun 2023

- Managed a $5M closed-business portfolio and $8M open pipeline across AWS, Salesforce and Snowflake alliances.

ALLCLOUD | Senior Executive Assistant to CEO | 2018 – 2021

- Connected CEO, board and leadership team through board preparation, executive planning and offsites.

CROCS | FACTION | LI & FUNG | Executive & Operations Roles | 2009 – 2018

- Delivered cross-functional projects, HR and benefits operations, onboarding, and a $500K office remodel and relocation.

TECHNOLOGY & LEADERSHIP

AI agents & workflow automation • Claude (Co-Worker, Code, Design) • ChatGPT • Gemini • Executive dashboards • HubSpot • Salesforce • Workday • ADP • Drata • Google Workspace • Microsoft 365

Community: Court Appointed Special Advocate (CASA); former adaptive ski instructor; led employee volunteer initiatives at AllCloud and Crocs.